commitment to be a partner in the development of the continent as he had committed to South African President Thabo Mbeki.

While Tata Power continued its efforts to expand and grow by following Ratan's plan, the development of India's power sector was stymied. At the company's AGM in 2012, Ratan said that the 'main challenge faced by the power sector in India' arose 'from difficulties regarding acquisition of land and obtaining environmental clearances'. He stated that the country's energy needs could be largely met by coal, which was in short supply, and appealed to the government to address the issues relating to the auctioning of coal blocks and lands. He called for pragmatic reforms at the government level as the challenges were 'daunting' and could simply not 'be met by the private sector alone'. He added, 'We have to accept that the country's growth rate depends on power being available. Looking ahead, the major challenge is the availability of energy at affordable prices.'

While he highlighted these problems, Ratan also said, 'Power is a business with a terrific future. Having adequate power will ensure the growth story of India. Tata Power is the largest integrated power operator in India and is positioned and poised with the wherewithal to grow domestically and has a goal to grow internationally too.'

On this optimistic note, Ratan retired at the end of 2012 with Tata Power as the largest electricity producer in the private sector. He had succeeded in achieving a 421 per cent increase in the power generation capacity during his tenure as chairman. Further, Tata Power's NPAT, which was Rs 160.33 crore as of March 1998 rose to Rs 1169.73 crore as of March 2012, in the thirteen years Ratan was the company's chairman. During Ratan's chairmanship of the group, Tata Power saw its revenue grow by over 2,715 per cent or increased twenty-eight times. A total of thirty-nine new power projects were also commissioned under Ratan's leadership.